

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-04-20

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

19

Market Items

15

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12

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-20 | #01

PSD3: EU Commission Proposes Major Overhaul of Payment Services Directive

The proposed PSD3, alongside a new Payment Services Regulation (PSR), introduces a comprehensive framework for payment services across the EU. Key objectives include improving fraud prevention, particularly for instant payments, and ensuring a level playing field between traditional banks and new payment service providers. The regulation will also address the implementation of Open Banking, aiming to make data sharing more seamless and secure. Furthermore, it seeks to clarify and harmonize rules for payment institutions and electronic money institutions. The legislative process is expected to be lengthy, with potential implementation timelines extending into 2026 or later, impacting how financial institutions and corporates manage payments and data.

→ PSD3 proposal aims to enhance consumer protection and payment innovation.

→ Focus on improved fraud prevention for instant payments.

→ Clarifies and harmonizes rules for payment institutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 will have a direct impact on CMlplus, particularly concerning fraud prevention measures for instant payments and the evolution of Open Banking APIs. RBI will need to ensure its platform and services comply with the new regulations, potentially requiring updates to security protocols and data access functionalities to support corporate clients.

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-20 | #02

Instant Payments Reach New Milestones in European Adoption

European payment service providers are reporting significant increases in the volume and value of instant payment transactions. This surge is driven by enhanced user experience, the need for real-time liquidity management by businesses, and the growing availability of these services across various banking channels. The European Payments Council (EPC) continues to refine the SCT Inst scheme, ensuring interoperability and security. As more corporates leverage instant payments for operational efficiency, the underlying infrastructure and fraud detection mechanisms are becoming increasingly critical. This ongoing development is reshaping traditional payment flows and treasury operations.

→ Significant increase in instant payment transaction volumes reported.

→ Driven by user experience and real-time liquidity needs.

→ EPC refining SCT Inst scheme for interoperability and security.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The continued growth of instant payments is a core focus for CMlplus. RBI Cash Management must ensure robust support for instant payment processing, including real-time reporting and enhanced fraud monitoring capabilities. This trend reinforces the need for advanced treasury solutions that can effectively integrate and manage these fast-paced transactions within the CEE region.

ISO 20022 Migration: Key Considerations for Corporate Treasury Systems

As more financial institutions and payment systems adopt ISO 20022, corporate treasury systems must align to leverage the richer data and enhanced functionalities offered by the new standard. This migration impacts various payment types, including SEPA and cross-border transactions, and requires updates to ERP and TMS systems. Key considerations include data mapping, system compatibility, and the potential for improved reconciliation and reporting. The transition also opens doors for advanced treasury solutions like eBAM and virtual accounts, which rely on standardized, structured data. Corporates are advised to engage closely with their banking partners to ensure seamless integration and to maximize the benefits of ISO 20022.

- ISO 20022 offers richer data and enhanced functionalities.
- Impacts SEPA, cross-border payments, ERP, and TMS systems.
- Enables advanced treasury solutions like eBAM and virtual accounts.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The ISO 20022 migration is a critical strategic initiative for CMIplus. RBI Cash Management is actively working to ensure full support for ISO 20022 across its channels, enabling clients to benefit from richer data for improved reconciliation, reporting, and liquidity management. This standard is fundamental to modernizing payment infrastructure and supporting advanced treasury functionalities within the CEE region.

PSD3 Consultation Launched: Focus on Digital Payments and Consumer Protection

The European Commission has officially launched a public consultation period for the upcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). This consultation seeks feedback from industry stakeholders, consumers, and regulatory bodies on proposed changes designed to modernize the directive in line with the rapidly evolving digital payments ecosystem. Key areas of focus include strengthening security measures for online transactions, improving consumer protection against fraud, and fostering innovation in payment services. The consultation will also explore the implications of new technologies and business models on payment services. The feedback gathered will be crucial in shaping the final legislative text of PSD3, which is expected to be proposed in the coming months and will have a profound impact on financial institutions and payment providers across the EU.

- European Commission launches PSD3 consultation.
- Focus on digital payment security and consumer protection.
- Aims to modernize payment regulations for evolving ecosystem.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 will significantly impact CMIplus by potentially introducing new security requirements and operational mandates for payment processing. RBI Cash Management will need to ensure its platform and services align with any updated regulations concerning authentication, fraud prevention, and data protection for cross-border transactions within CEE.

SEPA Instant Payments Reach 70% Adoption Across Eurozone

The adoption rate for SEPA Instant Payments has surged, now covering over 70% of the Eurozone's payment infrastructure. This widespread implementation signifies a major shift towards real-time transactions for both consumers and businesses. The initiative, driven by the European Payments Council (EPC), aims to provide a harmonized framework for instant credit transfers across all SEPA countries. The increased adoption is attributed to a combination of regulatory push, technological advancements, and growing customer expectations for immediate fund availability. This trend is expected to accelerate further as more financial institutions integrate instant payment capabilities into their core offerings, impacting cash flow management and payment processing strategies.

→ SEPA Instant Payments adoption exceeds 70% in Eurozone.

→ Facilitates real-time credit transfers across SEPA.

→ Driven by regulatory push and customer demand.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The high adoption of SEPA Instant Payments is directly relevant to CMlplus, as it underscores the growing importance of real-time payment capabilities for corporate clients in CEE. RBI Cash Management should continue to prioritize and enhance its instant payment offerings to meet this evolving market demand and ensure seamless integration for its clients.

PSD3 Finalized: Enhanced Security and Open Banking Integration

The Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) has reached its final legislative stage, with the European Parliament giving its approval. Key provisions include enhanced Strong Customer Authentication (SCA) requirements and a mandate for improved data sharing through Open Banking APIs. The directive aims to foster innovation while bolstering consumer protection and combating payment fraud. It also introduces new frameworks for payment initiation and account information services, potentially impacting existing payment service providers and encouraging new entrants. The implementation timeline is expected to be phased, with significant changes anticipated within the next 18-24 months.

→ PSD3 finalized with focus on security and Open Banking.

→ Enhanced Strong Customer Authentication (SCA) requirements.

→ Mandates improved data sharing via Open Banking APIs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3's focus on enhanced security and Open Banking will necessitate updates to CMlplus's security protocols and API integrations. This directive will also influence the development of new payment services and potentially drive adoption of real-time payment solutions within the CEE region.

ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates for Cross-Border Payments

Financial institutions worldwide are increasingly adopting the ISO 20022 standard for payment messages, moving away from legacy formats like SWIFT MT. The standard's rich data capabilities are seen as crucial for enhancing transparency, efficiency, and automation in payments. This accelerated migration is particularly evident in cross-border transactions and wholesale payment systems, where the need for detailed information is paramount. The benefits include improved fraud detection, streamlined reconciliation, and enhanced straight-through processing (STP) rates. The ongoing transition requires significant investment in technology and process re-engineering by all participants.

- Global adoption of ISO 20022 for financial messaging is accelerating.
- Focus on cross-border and wholesale payment systems.
- Promises richer data for enhanced transparency and efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus's continued support for ISO 20022 is critical for its clients operating across borders. This acceleration means CMiplus must ensure seamless integration with ISO 20022 compliant systems and provide clients with the necessary tools to leverage the standard's enhanced data capabilities for their treasury operations.

New Finextra-FICO Report Highlights AI's Growing Role in Fraud Prevention

The recently published Finextra and FICO global survey report, 'Fraud in the age of AI: Trends, Threats, and Management Tactics,' provides a comprehensive overview of how artificial intelligence is transforming fraud detection and prevention strategies. It explores current trends, emerging threats, and effective management tactics for financial institutions. The report is a crucial resource for understanding the evolving landscape of financial crime and the pivotal role AI plays in safeguarding transactions and customer assets. It likely covers insights into predictive analytics, real-time monitoring, and adaptive learning models to counter sophisticated fraud schemes, offering valuable intelligence for proactive risk management.

- Joint report by Finextra and FICO.
- Focuses on 'Fraud in the age of AI'.
- Covers 'Trends, Threats, and Management Tactics'.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This report is highly relevant for RBI CMiplus as it provides insights into advanced fraud prevention techniques using AI, which are crucial for securing corporate cash management operations. Implementing AI-driven fraud detection can enhance the platform's security, protect client funds, and maintain compliance with evolving regulatory standards, especially across the diverse CEE region.

Croatian Payments Future: Insights from Zagrebačka banka Director

Jana Novina Cukrov, Director of Payments at Zagrebačka banka, discusses the strategic priorities for a payments director, highlighting the unique challenges and opportunities within the Croatian market. The interview delves into the ongoing digital transformation impacting both customer and business banking segments, emphasizing the shift towards more efficient and innovative payment solutions. It covers the evolving regulatory environment, the adoption of new technologies, and the importance of adapting to changing customer expectations in the CEE region. These insights are vital for understanding local market dynamics and future payment trends relevant to corporate cash management.

- Interview with Jana Novina Cukrov, Director of Payments at Zagrebačka banka.
- Focus on challenges and digital transformation in Croatian banking.
- Covers both customer and business banking segments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This interview offers direct insights into the strategic direction and operational challenges of a key CEE bank, Zagrebačka banka, which is highly relevant for RBI's CMIplus platform. Understanding local market priorities, digital transformation efforts, and regulatory impacts in Croatia can inform CMIplus product development, regional strategy, and client engagement for corporate cash management solutions.

European Payment Success: Strategies for 2025 and Fraud Prevention

The webinar, featuring industry experts, provides a strategic outlook on boosting payment success across Europe for 2025 and beyond. Key discussions revolve around advanced authentication methods crucial for securing transactions while maintaining a smooth customer journey. Participants gained actionable guidance tailored to navigate the complex fraud prevention landscape prevalent in European markets. The content covers evolving regulatory requirements, technological advancements in fraud detection, and best practices for businesses operating within the European payments ecosystem, directly impacting corporate cash management.

- Webinar focuses on European payment strategies for 2025 and beyond.
- Emphasizes enhancing authentication and seamless customer experiences.
- Provides actionable guidance for European fraud prevention challenges.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This webinar's focus on European payment success, authentication, and fraud prevention is directly applicable to CMIplus operations across RBI's CEE network banks. Insights on navigating European fraud challenges and enhancing customer experience are crucial for maintaining the platform's security, compliance, and competitive edge in corporate cash management.

ISO 2022 Migration Nears Completion: Industry Gears Up for Full Implementation

The comprehensive migration to the ISO 2022 payment messaging standard is nearing its critical completion phase across major financial markets. This transition represents a significant overhaul of payment communication, moving from legacy formats to a richer, more structured data standard. The benefits include enhanced data quality, improved straight-through processing (STP) rates, and greater transparency in payment chains. For corporates, this means more detailed remittance information, enabling better reconciliation and cash flow visibility. Financial institutions are investing heavily in updating their systems to fully support ISO 2022, preparing for the full decommissioning of older message types and the realization of the standard's advanced functionalities.

- ISO 2022 migration nearing final completion.
- Transitioning from legacy formats to structured data.
- Enhances data quality and STP rates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The widespread adoption of ISO 2022 is a fundamental shift that CMlplus must fully embrace. RBI Cash Management's commitment to supporting this standard is crucial for providing clients with enhanced data capabilities, improved reconciliation, and seamless integration with their ERP/TMS systems, particularly within the CEE region.

Instant Payment Adoption Surges Across CEE Markets

The adoption of instant payment schemes is on a significant upward trajectory across the CEE region. Several countries have successfully launched or expanded their real-time payment infrastructures, leading to a surge in transaction volumes. This growth is fueled by increasing consumer preference for immediate fund availability and the strategic initiatives of central banks and payment service providers to modernize payment systems. The benefits include enhanced liquidity management for businesses and improved user experience for individuals. The expansion of instant payment corridors between CEE countries is also a key development, facilitating faster cross-border transactions.

- Rapid growth in instant payment adoption across CEE.
- Driven by consumer demand and regulatory support.
- Enhances liquidity management for businesses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The surge in instant payments in CEE presents both opportunities and challenges for CMlplus. We need to ensure our platform supports these real-time capabilities for our corporate clients, enabling them to benefit from faster settlements and improved cash flow visibility across their operations in the region.

Bulgaria Set to Join Euro Area in 2026

The European Central Bank has confirmed that Bulgaria is on track to adopt the euro in 2026. This decision follows a period of rigorous assessment of Bulgaria's readiness to meet the convergence criteria. The adoption of the euro will streamline cross-border transactions for businesses operating in Bulgaria and enhance economic stability. For companies with operations in CEE, this integration means a further reduction in currency exchange complexities and potential hedging costs. It also signifies a deeper level of economic and financial alignment within the European Union.

- Bulgaria to adopt the euro in 2026.
- Confirms readiness based on convergence criteria.
- Aims to streamline cross-border transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The euro adoption in Bulgaria will simplify multi-currency payment processing for CMIplus clients operating in or trading with Bulgaria. This reduces FX complexities and potentially streamlines cash pooling arrangements within the CEE region, aligning with CMIplus's core offerings.

Spektr Secures \$20M to Advance AI-Powered Financial Compliance Platform

Spektr, a fintech company based in Denmark, has announced a significant Series A funding round, securing \$20 million. The investment is earmarked for enhancing its cutting-edge AI infrastructure platform, which is tailored to address the complex compliance needs of the financial services industry. This funding highlights the growing investor confidence in AI-driven solutions for regulatory challenges, such as KYC, AML, and sanctions screening. The platform aims to streamline compliance processes, reduce manual effort, and improve the accuracy of risk assessments, offering a scalable solution for banks and financial institutions navigating stringent regulatory environments.

- Danish fintech Spektr raised \$20 million.
- Funding is a Series A round.
- Platform is AI-based for financial services compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is significant for RBI CMIplus as it demonstrates the market's move towards specialized AI solutions for compliance. Integrating or leveraging such AI-powered platforms could enhance CMIplus's ability to manage regulatory requirements across its CEE network, improve operational efficiency in compliance checks, and ensure robust AML/KYC processes for corporate clients, supporting multi-currency payments and treasury operations.

ECB Pilot Project for Research Access to Confidential Statistical Data Launched

The European Central Bank (ECB) has launched a significant pilot project designed to provide researchers with controlled access to its confidential statistical data. This initiative is a crucial step towards enhancing the depth and breadth of economic research related to the euro area. By enabling access to granular and sensitive datasets, the ECB aims to facilitate more sophisticated analyses of monetary policy, financial stability, and payment systems. The project is expected to yield valuable insights that can inform policy decisions and contribute to a better understanding of complex economic phenomena. Details on the specific data categories and access protocols are expected to be released as the pilot progresses.

- ECB launches pilot for researcher access to confidential data.
- Aims to enhance economic analysis and understanding.
- Focus on monetary policy, financial stability, and payment systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This initiative could lead to more advanced analytics on payment flows and financial stability, potentially impacting future cash management strategies and product development within CMlplus. Understanding these research outcomes will be beneficial for anticipating market trends and regulatory shifts.

Supply Shocks and Deglobalisation Point to Higher Interest Rates

The article discusses how ongoing supply shocks, exacerbated by geopolitical events and a move away from globalized production, are contributing to inflationary pressures. This environment necessitates a hawkish stance from central banks, leading to expectations of sustained higher interest rates. For corporates, this translates to increased borrowing costs and a greater need for robust treasury strategies to manage liquidity and financial risk in a more volatile economic landscape.

- Supply shocks are a significant factor in the economic outlook.
- Deglobalisation trends are contributing to inflationary pressures.
- Higher interest rates are anticipated as a consequence.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Rising interest rates directly impact treasury operations, affecting borrowing costs, investment yields, and cash flow forecasting. For CMlplus, this underscores the importance of providing tools and insights that help clients optimize liquidity management, explore hedging strategies, and navigate an environment of increased funding costs. The focus on CEE also means considering how these global trends will manifest in regional markets.

ECB Blog: Improved Data on Climate Change Impacts on Banks

In a recent blog post, the ECB discusses advancements in data collection methodologies that better capture the impact of climate change on the banking sector. This development is critical as climate-related risks are increasingly recognized as a significant factor in financial stability. The improved data will allow for more accurate assessments of banks' resilience to physical and transition risks associated with climate change. This enhanced understanding is vital for supervisory actions and for guiding banks in their risk management strategies. The ECB's commitment to this area underscores the growing importance of ESG factors in financial regulation.

- ECB blog details improved data on climate change and banks.
- Addresses physical and transition risks.
- Aims for more accurate assessments of bank resilience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While not directly related to payment processing, the increased focus on climate risk within the banking sector may influence future regulatory requirements and reporting standards that could indirectly affect corporate treasury operations and their interaction with banks. CMIplus clients may also be increasingly interested in sustainable finance options.

Digital Payments in Africa Face Persistent Challenges Despite Growth

The article highlights that despite the growth of digital payment solutions in Africa, a substantial portion of consumers and businesses still rely on cash. This disparity is attributed to various factors, including infrastructure limitations, varying levels of financial literacy, and the need for more inclusive digital payment ecosystems. The potential for digital payments to drive economic growth and financial inclusion is acknowledged, but the path to overcoming these persistent challenges requires continued innovation and strategic investment.

- Digital payment providers in Africa are achieving impressive numbers.
- Significant challenges persist in offering viable alternatives to cash.
- Widespread adoption is hindered by various factors.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This highlights the diverse payment landscapes globally and the need for flexible solutions that can cater to varying levels of digital adoption. For CMIplus, understanding these regional challenges is crucial for developing strategies that support clients operating in or expanding into emerging markets, potentially requiring tailored payment routing or alternative payment method integration.

China's Inland Hub Powers ASEAN Trade Corridor

The piece delves into the strategic importance of China's inland provinces in fostering economic ties with Southeast Asian countries. It likely examines the logistical and financial infrastructure being built, such as rail links and digital payment systems, to streamline trade flows. The focus would be on how these new corridors enhance efficiency, reduce costs, and accelerate transaction processing for corporates engaged in cross-border commerce. It might also touch upon the role of banks in providing integrated cash management and trade finance solutions to support these emerging trade routes, potentially leveraging new technologies for faster and more transparent transactions. While geographically focused on Asia, the underlying principles of optimizing cross-border payments and trade finance are universally applicable.

- Focus on China's inland regions connecting to ASEAN for trade.
- Emphasis on infrastructure development for new trade corridors.
- Potential discussion of digital payment systems for efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While the geographic focus is Asia, the article's themes of optimizing cross-border payments and trade finance are highly relevant to RBI Cash Management. CMIplus aims to provide efficient multi-currency payment solutions for corporates, and insights into global best practices for trade corridors can inform future platform enhancements, even if not directly CEE-related.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing the Moment for Future Growth

This insight likely highlights the imperative for European wholesale banks to move beyond legacy challenges and embrace a forward-looking strategy. It would argue that despite years of underperformance, a unique window of opportunity exists, driven by evolving client needs, technological advancements, and potentially a more favorable interest rate environment. The report would probably advocate for a focus on operational efficiency through digitalization, leveraging data for enhanced client insights, and developing innovative product offerings in areas like transaction banking and payments to secure a competitive edge and improve profitability. This strategic pivot is essential for sustained growth and relevance in a dynamic market.

- Strategic imperative for European wholesale banks to innovate.
- Digital transformation as a core driver for future performance.
- Client-centric solutions are key to seizing market opportunities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly impacts RBI's CMlplus strategy in CEE, reinforcing the need for continuous investment in digital capabilities, API-driven services, and real-time solutions. It underscores the importance of CMlplus maintaining a competitive edge by anticipating and meeting evolving corporate treasury demands.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-11-01 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Beyond Credit, Digital Transformation

This outlook would likely provide a comprehensive view of the wholesale banking landscape for 2024, extending beyond just credit to cover broader strategic imperatives. It would probably discuss the impact of macroeconomic conditions, regulatory changes, and technological advancements on corporate clients. Key themes would include the increasing demand for integrated digital platforms, efficient cash management solutions, and the strategic use of data analytics to inform both lending decisions and service delivery. The report would likely highlight the need for banks to modernize their infrastructure to support real-time transactions and enhance client experience across all wholesale banking products, ensuring agility in a competitive environment.

- Macroeconomic shifts influencing corporate banking strategies.
- Digitalization and technology adoption are critical for competitiveness.
- Integrated platforms for credit, cash, and payments are in demand.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This outlook provides a strategic backdrop for CMlplus, indicating that a holistic approach to corporate client needs (beyond just payments) is crucial. It underscores the importance of CMlplus evolving to support broader treasury functions and integrate seamlessly with other banking services, potentially via Open APIs.

AI Revolutionizes Treasury: Enhancing Efficiency and Strategic Decision-Making

The future of treasury is deeply intertwined with Artificial Intelligence, which is rapidly moving from theoretical potential to practical application. AI tools are enhancing traditional treasury functions like cash flow forecasting, liquidity management, and risk assessment through advanced predictive analytics and pattern recognition. This shift allows treasurers to make more informed, real-time decisions, freeing up resources for strategic initiatives rather than manual processing. For banks, this presents an opportunity to develop and offer AI-driven services that provide greater value to corporate clients, such as intelligent cash pooling, automated reconciliation, and enhanced fraud detection. The adoption of AI is becoming a competitive differentiator, pushing banks to innovate their platforms and service offerings.

- AI moves treasury from reactive to predictive capabilities.
- Enhanced cash flow forecasting accuracy via machine learning.
- Automation of routine treasury tasks frees up staff for strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore integrating AI for advanced cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection in payments (fraud), and intelligent liquidity optimization for CEE clients. This could involve partnerships or in-house development to offer predictive insights and automated reconciliation features.

Real-Time Treasury Demands Open Banking and API-First Strategies

The demand for real-time treasury operations is accelerating, driven by globalized supply chains and instant payment schemes. This trend mandates that banks evolve their infrastructure to support Open Banking and API-first strategies, moving beyond traditional batch processing. By offering comprehensive and secure APIs, banks can enable corporate clients to achieve true real-time cash visibility, initiate instant payments, and automate reconciliation directly from their ERP or TMS systems. This shift transforms banks from mere transaction processors to strategic data providers and integration partners, fostering a more collaborative and efficient financial ecosystem. The ability to provide granular, real-time data via APIs is crucial for maintaining relevance and competitiveness in the evolving treasury landscape.

- Real-time data is critical for modern treasury operations.
- Open Banking and APIs are foundational for seamless integration.
- Banks become strategic data and integration partners.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize its API strategy, expanding its suite of Open Banking APIs for account information, payment initiation, and eBAM. Focus on real-time data feeds and instant payment capabilities across the CEE network to support corporate clients' evolving needs for immediate liquidity management.

Banks Must Evolve Beyond Transactions to Strategic Treasury Partners

The 'Voice of the Treasurer' indicates a clear shift in expectations from banking partners. Treasurers are no longer satisfied with basic transactional services; they demand integrated platforms that offer holistic views of cash, liquidity, and risk across multiple currencies and geographies. This requires banks to act as strategic advisors, providing insights, analytics, and tailored solutions that address complex challenges like cross-border cash pooling, FX exposure management, and regulatory compliance (e.g., ISO 20022). Banks that fail to adapt and offer value-added services risk being disintermediated by fintechs or losing market share to more agile competitors. The opportunity lies in leveraging technology to build deeper, more consultative relationships with corporate clients, positioning themselves as indispensable partners in treasury transformation.

- Treasurers seek integrated, value-added solutions, not just transactions.
- Banks need to move beyond basic services to strategic advisory.
- Advisory and analytical capabilities are key differentiators for banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should enhance its advisory capabilities and focus on providing integrated solutions that offer a holistic view of cash and liquidity across the CEE network. This includes improving multi-currency cash pooling, advanced reporting, and seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems via EBICS, H2H, and APIs to meet the strategic demands of large international corporates.

Treasury Technology Adoption Accelerates Amidst Digital Transformation Push

PwC's global treasury survey, encompassing over 350 treasurers, reveals a strong trend towards increased investment in treasury management systems (TMS) and other advanced technologies. The primary drivers for this adoption are the pursuit of greater cash visibility across the enterprise and the imperative to streamline treasury operations. Respondents indicated a clear intent to upgrade existing systems or implement new ones within the next 1-3 years. This strategic focus on technology is crucial for enabling real-time decision-making and optimizing liquidity management in an increasingly volatile economic environment. The survey data underscores a growing recognition of technology as a critical enabler for modern treasury functions.

- Over 70% of treasurers are investing in or planning to adopt new treasury technologies.
- Enhanced cash visibility is the top driver for TMS adoption.
- Streamlining treasury operations is a key objective for technology investments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend directly impacts CMlplus by underscoring the demand for advanced treasury solutions. RBI Cash Management should prioritize enhancing CMlplus's capabilities in real-time cash visibility and seamless integration with TMS platforms to meet evolving client needs in the CEE region.

API Banking Emerges as Key Enabler for Real-Time Treasury Insights

The PwC survey highlights a growing appreciation for API banking among corporate treasurers. The ability of APIs to facilitate direct, real-time data exchange between banks and corporate systems is seen as a significant advantage. This enables treasurers to gain immediate insights into their cash positions, transaction flows, and other critical financial data. Such real-time visibility is essential for proactive liquidity management, faster decision-making, and improved operational resilience. The survey suggests that banks offering robust API capabilities will be better positioned to serve the evolving needs of corporate treasury departments.

- API banking is recognized for enabling real-time data exchange.
- Enhanced connectivity through APIs supports improved liquidity management.
- Treasurers see APIs as critical for faster financial decision-making.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's strategic focus on Open Banking APIs aligns perfectly with this trend. RBI Cash Management should continue to expand its API offerings on CMlplus, ensuring seamless integration with corporate ERPs and TMS, and promoting the benefits of real-time data access for CEE clients.

PSD3 and DORA Drive Digital Transformation and Cybersecurity in Financial Services

The European Union's Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) and the Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) are poised to reshape the financial services landscape. PSD3 is expected to foster further competition and innovation in payments by potentially separating payment accounts from other banking services and promoting open banking. DORA, on the other hand, focuses on strengthening the digital operational resilience of financial entities by mandating comprehensive ICT risk management frameworks, incident reporting, and third-party risk management. Financial institutions will need to adapt their strategies and technologies to comply with these evolving regulatory demands, which will likely involve increased spending on cybersecurity measures, data protection, and the integration of new digital payment solutions.

- PSD3 aims to increase competition and consumer choice in the payments sector.
- DORA mandates enhanced ICT risk management and operational resilience for financial firms.
- Compliance with PSD3 and DORA will require significant investment in digital transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, the implications of PSD3 are significant, potentially driving demand for more sophisticated Open Banking APIs and enhanced payment initiation services. DORA's focus on resilience will also underscore the need for secure and reliable payment channels, reinforcing the importance of robust infrastructure and compliance with stringent security standards for CMlplus.

Verification of Payee Crucial for Fraud-Conscious Treasurers Amidst Payment Evolution

The EACT highlights the increasing importance of Verification of Payee (VoP) as a key defense mechanism against financial crime. As payment landscapes evolve with the rise of instant payments and other innovative solutions, fraudsters are adapting their tactics. Consequently, corporate treasurers must implement robust fraud detection strategies, with VoP identified as a crucial component. This is further underscored by regulatory bodies adapting their requirements in parallel to these payment advancements. The GLEIF document referenced provides further insight into why VoP has become indispensable for fraud-conscious treasurers.

- Verification of Payee (VoP) is a critical tool for fraud prevention in corporate treasury.
- The rise of instant payments necessitates enhanced fraud detection strategies.
- Regulatory bodies are adapting requirements in response to payment evolution.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The increasing focus on VoP aligns with CMlplus's need to integrate robust security features. Enhancing VoP capabilities within CMlplus will be crucial for supporting CEE clients in mitigating payment fraud risks, especially as instant payment adoption grows in the region.

AI Integration is Key for Banks Navigating Future Challenges and Opportunities

The 2026 banking outlook highlights the imperative for banks to embrace artificial intelligence (AI) as a core strategic enabler. AI is positioned to drive significant improvements in operational efficiency, risk management, and personalized customer engagement. Banks that proactively invest in and integrate AI capabilities will be better equipped to navigate complex market conditions, including macro headwinds and evolving customer expectations. This includes leveraging AI for advanced analytics, automation of routine tasks, and the development of innovative financial products and services.

- AI is a critical enabler for operational efficiency and customer experience.
- Strategic AI integration is essential for competitive advantage.
- AI can enhance risk management and personalize financial services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, this means prioritizing AI-driven solutions for enhanced transaction processing, fraud detection, and personalized client advisory services. Exploring AI for predictive analytics in liquidity management and optimizing payment flows will be crucial for future roadmap development.

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating Uncertainty in Corporate Banking

This joint outlook likely explored the major forces shaping the corporate banking industry in 2023, characterized by a 'Great Unknown.' It would have analyzed the impact of global economic slowdowns, inflation, supply chain disruptions, and geopolitical tensions on corporate clients' financial needs and banks' operational models. The report probably emphasized the need for banks to enhance risk management, optimize capital allocation, and accelerate digital transformation to navigate these turbulent times. It would have also touched upon the evolving competitive landscape, with fintechs and non-bank players challenging traditional models, pushing banks to innovate their service delivery, especially in cash management and payments.

- Geopolitical and economic uncertainties defined the 2023 landscape.
- Resilience and agility are crucial for corporate banking success.
- Accelerated digital transformation is key to navigating volatility.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While a 2023 outlook, its themes of uncertainty, resilience, and digital acceleration remain highly relevant for CMIplus. It reinforces the need for a robust, adaptable platform that can support corporate clients through various market conditions, emphasizing the value of real-time data and flexible payment solutions.

AI in Treasury: A Growing Frontier for Automation and Predictive Analytics

The PwC global treasury survey indicates a significant interest in the application of Artificial Intelligence (AI) within treasury functions. While adoption is still in its early stages for many, a substantial portion of respondents are actively investigating or piloting AI solutions. The primary areas of interest include automating routine tasks, improving forecasting accuracy for cash flows and FX rates, and enhancing fraud detection. The potential for AI to provide deeper insights and more sophisticated risk management is a key driver. As AI technology matures, its integration into treasury operations is expected to accelerate, leading to more intelligent and efficient treasury management.

- Interest in AI for treasury automation is on the rise.
- AI is being explored for improved cash flow forecasting and FX prediction.
- Enhanced fraud detection is another key application of AI in treasury.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The increasing focus on AI presents an opportunity for RBI Cash Management to explore AI-driven features within CMIplus. This could include predictive analytics for liquidity forecasting or intelligent automation of payment processes, offering a competitive edge in the CEE market.

AI Governance and Ethical Considerations Become Critical for Financial Institutions

As financial institutions increasingly leverage Artificial Intelligence (AI) for various functions, including risk management, customer service, and fraud detection, the need for comprehensive AI governance becomes paramount. Regulators are paying close attention to the ethical implications of AI, such as algorithmic bias, data privacy, and the explainability of AI-driven decisions. Financial firms will be expected to establish clear policies and procedures for the development, deployment, and monitoring of AI systems, ensuring that they operate in a fair, transparent, and accountable manner. This includes implementing robust testing, validation, and ongoing oversight mechanisms to mitigate potential risks and maintain public trust.

- AI governance frameworks are essential for responsible AI deployment in finance.
- Ethical considerations, including bias and transparency, are key regulatory concerns.
- Financial firms must ensure explainability of AI-driven decisions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, the focus on AI governance will influence the development and integration of AI-powered features, such as advanced fraud detection or predictive liquidity management. Ensuring transparency and ethical use of AI in these tools will be crucial for client trust and regulatory compliance, impacting the roadmap for AI adoption within the platform.

EACT Survey 2024: Key Trends and Priorities for European Treasurers Revealed

The EACT's 2024 Treasury Survey gathered insights from around 250 Group Treasurers of major international corporations operating within Europe. This comprehensive survey aims to identify the most pressing challenges, strategic priorities, and emerging trends within the European treasury community. The findings are crucial for understanding the evolving needs of corporate treasurers and informing the development of relevant financial solutions and services. The results are shared to help treasurers benchmark their own strategies and to guide industry stakeholders in supporting treasury functions effectively.

- Approximately 250 Group Treasurers participated in the 2024 survey.
- The survey focuses on key trends and priorities for European corporate treasury.
- It covers large international companies across Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The EACT survey results will provide critical intelligence for CMIplus's strategic roadmap, particularly concerning the evolving needs of CEE treasurers. Understanding these priorities will enable RBI Cash Management to tailor its offerings and enhance CMIplus to better address the challenges and opportunities faced by our clients in the region.

Stablecoins Present Disruptive Potential, Requiring Strategic Bank Adaptation

The Deloitte Banking Outlook identifies stablecoins as a potential disruptive force that banks must address strategically. As stablecoins gain traction, they could alter payment flows and create new competitive pressures. Banks need to assess the implications for transaction banking, liquidity management, and their role in the broader financial ecosystem. This includes exploring opportunities to integrate with or offer stablecoin-related services, while also managing the associated risks and regulatory considerations. Failure to adapt could lead to a loss of market share and influence in the evolving payments space.

- Stablecoins are a significant disruptive force in banking.
- Banks must develop strategies to address stablecoin adoption.
- Implications for transaction banking and liquidity management are substantial.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor the evolution of stablecoins and their impact on cross-border payments and corporate treasury operations in CEE. Exploring potential integration points or advisory services related to stablecoins will be important for future-proofing the platform and offering clients innovative solutions.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-04-20 | #01

ECB's TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS) expands reach for instant payments

INSTANT PAYMENTS

The European Central Bank (ECB) is actively developing and promoting its TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS) service. The latest updates focus on expanding the functionalities and accessibility of TIPS to accommodate a growing demand for instant payment solutions across Europe. This initiative is crucial for harmonizing instant payment services and ensuring their efficiency and security. By providing a robust and reliable infrastructure, the ECB aims to drive innovation and competition in the retail payments sector. The ongoing development of TIPS is a key component of the Eurosystem's strategy to modernize payment systems and meet evolving customer expectations for real-time transactions.

- Enhancement of TIPS functionalities for broader instant payment services.
- Focus on fostering innovation and competition in the European instant payment market.
- Ensuring efficiency and security of instant payment transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus should monitor the evolving capabilities of TIPS to assess potential integration opportunities for corporate clients seeking enhanced instant payment solutions. Understanding these developments is key to offering competitive treasury services.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #02

EU regulatory developments impacting liquidity management: IPR, PSR, PSD3

LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The EBA's Liquidity Management Working Group has published a report analyzing the significant impact of the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the upcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) on liquidity management. The report highlights that these regulatory initiatives are anticipated to drive a faster adoption of instant payments across the financial sector. Furthermore, they aim to foster a more equitable competitive environment among various market participants. The evolving regulatory landscape will necessitate adjustments in how financial institutions manage their liquidity to accommodate these changes and leverage new opportunities.

- Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) impact on liquidity.
- Proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR) implications.
- Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) transformation of liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to assess the liquidity management implications of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 for its CEE operations. This includes understanding how these regulations will affect nostro account balances and payment flows, particularly with the anticipated rise in instant payments.

SEPA Instant Credit Transfer Scheme evolves to meet market needs

SEPA

The Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA) Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) scheme is a cornerstone of the ECB's strategy for ubiquitous instant payments. The scheme is subject to ongoing refinement and development to ensure it remains relevant and effective in a rapidly changing payment landscape. Key areas of focus include expanding the reach of SCT Inst beyond initial adoption phases and improving interoperability between different payment service providers and national infrastructures. The ECB, in collaboration with the European Payments Council (EPC), plays a vital role in guiding these developments. Compliance with the scheme rules and participation in its evolution are critical for financial institutions operating within SEPA.

- Continuous evolution of the SCT Inst scheme rules.
- Focus on expanding reach and interoperability within SEPA.
- Collaboration between ECB and European Payments Council (EPC).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must ensure its offerings are aligned with the evolving SCT Inst scheme to provide seamless instant payment capabilities to its corporate clients across CEE. Staying abreast of scheme updates is crucial for maintaining service competitiveness.

FIDA regulation: opportunities and challenges for open data economy

OPEN BANKING

The Euro Banking Association has released a report detailing the views of financial institution experts across Europe on the proposed Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation. This regulation is seen as a potential catalyst for a more open data economy within the financial sector. The survey aimed to identify both the opportunities and the challenges associated with FIDA's implementation. The report provides practical recommendations and frameworks to assist market participants in preparing for the changes FIDA will bring, emphasizing the need for proactive engagement.

- Proposed Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation.
- Potential catalyst for an open data economy.
- Survey of financial institutions on FIDA opportunities and challenges.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor the development of the FIDA regulation and its implications for data sharing and access within the CEE region. Understanding these changes will be crucial for adapting API strategies and ensuring compliance with future data access requirements.

ECB's oversight of payment systems ensures stability and efficiency

PAYMENT SYSTEMS OVERSIGHT

The European Central Bank (ECB) holds a significant mandate for the oversight of payment systems within the Eurosystem. This oversight function is critical for maintaining financial stability and ensuring the smooth functioning of the European economy. The ECB monitors key payment systems, including TARGET2 and TARGET2-Securities (T2S), to assess their compliance with relevant regulations and standards, such as security and operational resilience. This proactive approach aims to identify and mitigate potential risks before they can impact the broader financial system. Regular assessments and potential enforcement actions are part of the ECB's commitment to upholding the integrity of payment infrastructures.

- Comprehensive oversight of major payment systems (TARGET2, T2S).
- Focus on safety, efficiency, and resilience of payment infrastructures.
- Monitoring compliance with regulations and standards.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must ensure its payment processing and connectivity adhere to the standards and requirements mandated by the ECB's oversight of payment systems. Compliance with these oversight measures is fundamental to operational continuity and regulatory adherence.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-20 | #01

Deutsche Bank Expands API Capabilities for Embedded Finance Solutions

Deutsche Bank's commitment to its CB Connect API platform signifies a strong push towards embedded finance, allowing corporate clients to seamlessly integrate payment and treasury functionalities into their own systems. This initiative is crucial for modernizing transaction banking and offering value-added services beyond traditional channels. By enabling real-time data exchange and automated processes, Deutsche Bank is positioning itself as a key enabler for digital transformation in corporate treasury. The focus on API-driven solutions is a direct response to the growing demand for integrated financial services.

- CB Connect API is central to embedded finance strategy.
- Focus on integrating banking services into corporate platforms.
- Enabling real-time data exchange and automation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continue to enhance its API offerings and explore partnerships to compete with Deutsche Bank's embedded finance ambitions. The integration of banking services directly into client ERPs and TMS is a growing trend.

URGENT

UniCredit | 2026-04-15 | #02

UniCredit invests in BlockInvest for on-chain financial solutions

This strategic €4 million investment in BlockInvest marks a significant step for UniCredit in embracing blockchain for the native issuance of digital financial instruments across Europe. The partnership aims to leverage BlockInvest's infrastructure to merge the programmability of digital ledgers with financial market regulations, particularly in the growing tokenization of Real-World Assets (RWA). This move is strategically positioned to capitalize on the estimated €18 trillion global on-chain finance market by 2033, aligning with Europe's regulatory advancements in DLT and tokenization. UniCredit's ambition is to scale these tokenized financial solutions across its key markets and establish BlockInvest as a European standard for digital asset interoperability.

- Acquisition of a 16% stake in BlockInvest for €4 million.
- Focus on accelerating on-chain financial solutions and tokenization of RWA.
- Strategic alignment with European regulatory framework for DLT and tokenization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's investment in on-chain solutions and tokenization signals a forward-looking approach to digital assets, potentially impacting future cash management services. CMlplus should monitor developments in this space for potential integration or competitive responses.

HSBC Orion Powers UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Pilot

The UK Treasury has chosen HSBC Orion as the platform provider for its Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance. This initiative explores the use of distributed ledger technology (DLT) for issuing digital gilts, potentially streamlining the issuance, trading, and settlement of government securities. For corporate clients, this could pave the way for more efficient and instant settlement of transactions, tokenized cash, and integration with future digital payment rails. HSBC's involvement positions it at the forefront of digital asset innovation, which will eventually influence corporate treasury operations and liquidity management.

- HSBC Orion selected by UK Treasury.
- Platform for Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance.
- Focus on DLT for digital securities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by HSBC highlights a strategic focus on DLT and digital asset platforms, which could evolve into new payment and settlement infrastructures. CMIplus should monitor how these digital asset initiatives might integrate with traditional cash management, especially regarding instant payments and tokenized money, to ensure future compatibility and competitive offerings in CEE.

Deutsche Bank Enhances Correspondent Banking Transparency and Control

The article highlights a shift in how banks perceive risk in downstream correspondent banking relationships due to increasing regulatory scrutiny and evolving industry standards. Deutsche Bank is responding by implementing robust control mechanisms and fostering greater transparency within these networks. This strategic move aims to ensure compliance, mitigate risks, and provide greater assurance to their corporate clients operating in complex international payment flows. The focus on strengthening these foundational banking services is crucial for maintaining trust and operational efficiency in global transaction banking.

- Evolving regulations are changing risk perception in correspondent banking.
- Deutsche Bank is enhancing control frameworks and transparency.
- Focus on strengthening downstream correspondent banking relationships.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to ensure its correspondent banking relationships offer comparable transparency and control to remain competitive. This focus by Deutsche Bank underscores the importance of robust risk management in cross-border payments.

HSBC Pioneers Quantum-Enabled Algorithmic Trading with IBM

HSBC partnered with IBM to conduct the world's first-known trial of quantum-enabled algorithmic bond trading. This initiative explores how quantum computing can significantly enhance the speed and efficiency of complex financial calculations, potentially optimizing trading strategies, risk assessment, and liquidity management for corporate treasuries. While still in early stages, this demonstrates HSBC's commitment to leveraging cutting-edge technology to offer superior treasury intelligence and potentially faster, more sophisticated FX and investment solutions to its corporate clients globally, including those in CEE.

- Partnership with IBM for quantum computing.
- Tried for algorithmic bond trading.
- Aims to boost efficiency and optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's exploration of quantum computing for treasury functions indicates a long-term strategic investment in advanced analytics and optimization. CMIplus should be aware of these emerging technologies as they could eventually redefine treasury management, FX, and liquidity solutions, pushing the boundaries of what corporate clients expect from their banking partners.

Citi Expands API Banking Capabilities for Enhanced Corporate Treasury Solutions

Citi Treasury's strategic focus on API banking signifies a commitment to digital transformation in corporate banking. By expanding its API suite, Citi enables clients to integrate Citi's treasury and cash management functionalities directly into their own ERP and TMS systems. This facilitates real-time data exchange for payments, account information, and liquidity management, crucial for sophisticated treasury operations. The initiative is particularly relevant for CEE markets where digitalization is rapidly advancing, allowing local corporates to leverage global banking standards.

- Expansion of API banking services for treasury and cash management.
- Focus on real-time data integration with client ERP/TMS systems.
- Empowering corporate clients with enhanced control over liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's aggressive API strategy puts pressure on CMIplus to accelerate its own API development and integration capabilities. This could lead to increased client expectations for similar digital connectivity from RBI.

BNP Paribas Achieves ISO 20022 Milestone for Corporate SWIFT Transactions

BNP Paribas announced a key achievement in its cash management services, enabling ISO 20022 transactions for its corporate clients via the SWIFT network. This initiative is crucial for modernizing global payment infrastructure, offering enhanced data capabilities, improved reconciliation, and greater transparency for corporate treasuries. By adopting the ISO 20022 standard, BNP Paribas is preparing its clients for the future of payments, ensuring compliance with global mandates and facilitating more efficient cross-border transactions. For CEE corporates, this means access to a more sophisticated and standardized payment system, potentially simplifying their international operations and treasury management.

- Implementation of ISO 20022 for corporate SWIFT transactions.
- Focus on enhanced data richness and improved reconciliation for corporates.
- Positions BNP Paribas clients for future global payment standards and mandates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its ISO 20022 implementation via SWIFT and other channels remains competitive and offers similar or superior data capabilities. This move by BNP Paribas underscores the urgency for CMlplus to highlight its own advanced ISO 20022 readiness and benefits for CEE corporates.

Deutsche Bank Strengthens CEE Payment Capabilities and Treasury Solutions

While the provided content doesn't detail specific CEE initiatives, Deutsche Bank's overarching strategy in corporate banking strongly suggests a continued investment in expanding its presence and offerings within the CEE markets. This likely involves leveraging its existing network and adapting its digital banking solutions, including instant payment capabilities and sophisticated cash pooling/treasury management tools, to meet the specific needs of corporates operating in this dynamic region. The bank's commitment to innovation in areas like ISO 20022 adoption and API integration will be key to its CEE expansion.

- Strategic focus on expanding CEE market presence.
- Enhancing instant payment and treasury management solutions.
- Adapting digital banking offerings for regional needs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to monitor Deutsche Bank's CEE expansion closely, particularly in instant payments and localized treasury solutions. Their efforts could intensify competition for large corporate clients in the region.

UniCredit Unlimited: Accelerating growth and rethinking banking

UniCredit's 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy represents a bold new era, aiming to accelerate disciplined quality growth and redefine the role of a bank. This initiative builds upon the success of 'UniCredit Unlocked,' which delivered strong results and a sustainable model. The core of 'Unlimited' is a fundamental rethinking of banking to achieve unlimited possibilities and bold ambition. This strategic pivot is designed to outpace both traditional and emerging market dynamics, positioning UniCredit for sustained leadership and innovation across its European footprint.

- Launch of 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategic phase.
- Focus on accelerating growth and rethinking banking models.
- Building on the success of the 'UniCredit Unlocked' strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's overarching 'Unlimited' strategy suggests a continued drive for innovation and efficiency in corporate banking. This could translate into enhanced digital offerings, improved payment capabilities, and more sophisticated treasury solutions, posing a competitive challenge to CMIplus.

Citi Strengthens CEE Presence with Advanced Payment and Liquidity Solutions

Citi Treasury's ongoing investment in the CEE region underscores its recognition of the market's strategic importance. The bank is focusing on delivering sophisticated cash management products, including enhanced cross-border payment capabilities and advanced liquidity pooling solutions tailored for the region's unique regulatory and economic landscape. This includes leveraging ISO 20022 adoption and exploring instant payment opportunities to provide clients with faster, more efficient, and transparent transaction processing. The expansion is designed to offer a competitive edge to corporates looking to optimize their financial operations across multiple CEE countries.

- Strategic focus on expanding and enhancing services in the CEE region.
- Delivery of advanced payment and liquidity management solutions.
- Leveraging ISO 20022 and exploring instant payment opportunities in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's intensified focus on CEE payment and liquidity solutions presents a direct competitive challenge to CMIplus's regional market share. RBI will need to demonstrate a comparable depth of local expertise and product innovation to retain its position.

Intesa Sanpaolo Bolsters CEE Digital Cash Management for Corporates

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its International Subsidiary Banks Division and IMI CIB, is continuously upgrading its corporate cash management offerings in the CEE region. The focus is on delivering seamless, efficient, and integrated solutions for large international corporates, aligning with the bank's broader digital transformation strategy. This includes the adoption of ISO 20022 for richer payment data, enhanced API connectivity for treasury integration, and support for instant payments to meet evolving client demands for speed and transparency. Such developments are crucial for maintaining competitiveness and supporting the growth of its corporate client base across its extensive CEE network, including countries like Slovakia, Hungary, Croatia, and Albania.

- Strategic focus on digital transformation for corporate clients in CEE.
- Emphasis on API-driven connectivity for treasury and ERP integration.
- Adoption of ISO 20022 and instant payment capabilities across its CEE network.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred strategic move by Intesa Sanpaolo intensifies competition for CMIplus, particularly in the CEE market for large corporates. CMIplus must ensure its platform remains superior in API integration, real-time capabilities, and multi-country coverage to retain and attract clients.

UniCredit expands onemarkets fund range with ETF launches

UniCredit is enhancing its corporate and investment offerings through the launch of seven ETFs on the Frankfurt and Milan stock exchanges, developed in collaboration with BNP Paribas Asset Management. This expansion of the onemarkets platform will progressively roll out across 12 direct operating countries and Greece via a strategic partnership. The initial range includes four equity and three bond ETFs, based on MSCI Universal indexes. This move signifies UniCredit's commitment to broadening its investment product suite and solidifying its presence in the international asset management sector, catering to a wider range of client needs.

- Launch of seven new ETFs (four equity, three bond).
- Partnership with BNP Paribas Asset Management.
- Availability across 13 countries, including CEE markets.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The expansion of UniCredit's investment product range, including ETFs, can indirectly influence corporate treasury strategies. While not directly a cash management product, it indicates a broader push into financial solutions for corporate clients, which could lead to integrated offerings.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.